QA worklist, easiest first

Generated 2026-11-08 from `runs/qa/2026-11-07-edits-ch00-ch16.json`*. Sorted by how hard each item is to address, not by how serious it is. Regenerated wholesale.*

Batch 1: accept in one go (45)

Small, one line each, one fix, no facts from you. My approach is under each; most are ’accept as written’.

Q064 · Prologue L45 · low

Now: “I want to be clear about that before saying anything else here.”

Problem: An announcement sentence, and false: it comes late in the Prologue.

Fix: Delete the sentence.

My call: Accept: delete.

Q065 · Prologue L53 · low

Now: “one ordinary day at a time”

Problem: The same phrase ends the Prologue and the Part I opener, which are read back to back.

Fix: Change the Prologue to ’day by ordinary day’.

My call: Accept as written.

Q021 · Ch1 L13 · medium

Now: “That three-second window is what this book is about.”

Problem: One of three competing thesis statements (Prologue: the armor mistake; Introduction: three qualities; Ch1: the window), and Part III is not about the window.

Fix: Keep the Ch1 L13 fix and add Prologue L33: ’A lot of this book was written to keep you from making it.’

My call: Accept both halves: Ch1 L13 becomes ’That three-second window is where all of this starts.’ and Prologue L33 becomes ’A lot of this book was written to keep you from making it.’

Q023 · Ch1 L87 · medium

Now: “The Stoic Husband stays reachable. He’s learned to pause in the place most men fire from.”

Problem: Shifts to a third-person model husband and an inferior crowd at the chapter’s turn.

Fix: ’Stay reachable. Pause in the place you used to fire from. That pause takes more presence than distance ever could.’

My call: Accept as written.

Q025 · Ch2 L10 · medium

Now: “Study that list. Her mood isn’t on either side.”

Problem: Misreads the quote: ’whatever are not our own acts’ plainly covers her mood, and a reader who knows the Enchiridion will catch it.

Fix: Replace the paragraph with: ’Study that list. Her mood isn’t named on it. Not her state of mind. Not the energy she carries through the door. It falls under the last line, with whatever are not your own acts, because other people’s inner states were never yours to work with.’

My call: Accept, minus the ’Not her...’ fragments the Anti-Slop Reader flags elsewhere: ’Study that list. Her mood isn’t named on it, but it falls under the last line, with whatever are not your own acts. Other

people’s inner states were never yours to work with.’

Q069 · Ch2 L38 · low

Now: “Your ungoverned arrival. An entire household in distress. Ending with an animal who had no part in any of it.”

Problem: A fragment chain with clinical nouns, and two ’Nobody…pass it’ sentences in a row.

Fix: Replace 38-40 with ’You came home carrying the day, and by bedtime the whole house had it, down to a dog that did nothing. Nobody meant to pass it on. It didn’t stop until it ran out of people.’

My call: Accept as written.

Q027 · Ch2 L64 · medium

Now: “Not suppress. Not eliminate.”

Problem: An orphaned echo of the removed De Ira quotation; it now answers nothing.

Fix: Delete ’Not suppress. Not eliminate. *Calm.*’ and begin the paragraph ’The goal is not to stop feeling.’

My call: Accept as written.

Q029 · Ch2 L80 · medium

Now: “These are the things you prefer. Worth tending, every one of them.”

Problem: ’These’ has no antecedent for thirty lines, and the paragraph makes a third ending after L78.

Fix: Her good days and her hard ones are things you prefer or don’t. Worth tending, every one of them.

My call: Accept as written.

Q071 · Ch3 L35 · low

Now: “She just updated her model of what it costs to bring things to you.”

Problem: Analytical jargon where recognition belongs (backlog, still present).

Fix: She just remembered how hard it was to tell you.

My call: Accept as written.

Q074 · Ch4 L59 · low

Now: “That’s where your *prohairesis* lives. Your capacity to choose. The part of you that chooses before you react.”

Problem: Partly fixed; glossed twice, and ’lives’ appears twice.

Fix: ’That’s where your *prohairesis* lives: your capacity to choose.’

My call: Accept as written.

Q075 · Ch4 L61 · low

Now: “He was writing to himself, leading an army through a war he didn’t choose, about what actual strength looks like.”

Problem: Repeats Ch1’s framing of Marcus word for word.

Fix: He was writing to himself, about what actual strength looks like.

My call: Accept as written.

Q076 · Ch4 L79 · low

Now: “That’s what most men miss.”

Problem: A ’most men’ foil in front of the chapter’s key line.

Fix: Delete; keep ’An apology pulls the nail. It doesn’t fill the hole.’

My call: Accept: delete.

Q034 · Ch5 L37 · medium

Now: “The withdrawal that punishes without naming itself. You go quiet in a specific way she can feel.”

Problem: Repeats Ch4’s cold-anger lines almost word for word, in the next chapter.

Fix: Cold anger, from the last chapter, is one. Not because you’re cooling down, but because you want her to know.

My call: Accept as written.

Q079 · Ch5 L53 · low

Now: “The couples who stay married for fifty years didn’t avoid fighting.”

Problem: Asserted without a source.

Fix: Couples who make it fifty years don’t avoid fighting.

My call: Accept as written.

Q036 · Ch6 L9 · medium

Now: “until the dog walks belong to you and the dishes belong to her”

Problem: The dishes are hers in L9 but his in L11 and L13.

Fix: until the dog walks belong to you and the laundry belongs to her

My call: Accept as written.

Q080 · Ch6 L11 · low

Now: “Here’s the part nobody warns you about:”

Problem: A windup plus an invented ’nobody’.

Fix: Begin ’Once the split happens, you mostly stop seeing her half of it.’

My call: Accept as written.

Q081 · Ch6 L13 · low

Now: “or coaching the flag football team because nobody else would”

Problem: The coaching example is repeated in Ch7, where it is central.

Fix: Delete the clause; end the sentence at ’running them through the wash.’

My call: Accept: delete the clause.

Q037 · Ch6 L41 · medium

Now: “When that verdict lands, you’ve got four ways to swing back”

Problem: Re-explains Ch3’s Four D’s in full, one Part later.

Fix: Replace L41-43 with: ’When that verdict lands, the Four D’s from Chapter 3 are right there: defend, deny, downplay, deflect. Each one feels justified, and each one turns a tired woman’s comment about laundry into a trial over your character.’ Keep L45-47.

My call: Accept as written.

Q082 · Ch6 L59 · low

Now: “Chapter 7 examines the ledger directly.”

Problem: The chapter’s last words are a signpost.

Fix: Delete; end on ’Giving freely doesn’t mean carrying an arrangement you can’t sustain.’

My call: Accept: delete.

Q084 · Ch7 L9 · low

Now: “like the ceiling fan that started clicking last month.”

Problem: Reuses Ch6’s ceiling fan in the next chapter.

Fix: It’s just yours. Like the TV that needed a new setting after the last software update.

My call: Accept as written.

Q085 · Ch7 L11 · low

Now: “And that’s exactly the problem this chapter is about.”

Problem: A meta signpost.

Fix: Delete.

My call: Accept: delete.

Q041 · Ch8 L5 · medium

Now: “The last chapter took the private tally apart.”

Problem: A recap opening (the third in the book) that starts outside the reader’s experience; unchanged since the 2026-09-23 fix was proposed.

Fix: You’ve done something for the family, and a small criticism is still bothering you days later. (Move the Ch7 link after L11.)

My call: Accept as written; the Line Editor moves the Ch7 link after L11.

Q087 · Ch8 L27 · low

Now: “Most men read it for a different reason, but it’s the right tool here.”

Problem: A crowd foil introducing the quote.

Fix: Delete the sentence.

My call: Accept: delete.

Q043 · Ch8 L33 · medium

Now: “She’s very likely not being cruel. She’s being unreflective,”

Problem: Raises cruelty only to dismiss it.

Fix: ’She’s seeing her side, the same way you’ve only seen yours a hundred times over.’

My call: Accept as written.

Q088 · Ch8 L57 · low

Now: “The next chapter looks at what happens when you stay quiet and expect something back.”

Problem: A signpost line sits between the last section and the closing line, making a double ending.

Fix: Move to the end of L55’s paragraph or cut it; end on L59.

My call: Cut the signpost rather than move it, so the chapter ends on L59.

Q089 · Ch9 L25 · low

Now: “The same kind of list Chapters 6 and 7 already described.”

Problem: Repeats line 17’s back-reference.

Fix: Delete the sentence.

My call: Accept: delete.

Q090 · Ch9 L27 · low

Now: “John Gottman spent decades studying what actually predicts divorce, and he found four warning signs”

Problem: Re-lists Gottman’s four signs (already in Ch3) and repeats Ch4’s disdain-to-contempt chain.

Fix: Contempt, the warning sign John Gottman found matters most, is what disappointment turns into when it never gets spoken and never gets addressed.

My call: Accept as written.

Q092 · Ch10 L6 · low

Now: “Epictetus spent his early life as a slave and the rest of it running a school.”

Problem: Near-verbatim repeat of Ch2’s introduction of Epictetus.

Fix: Epictetus, the former slave who became a teacher, wrote a handbook, the *Enchiridion*...

(merge into L7).

My call: Accept; the Line Editor merges L6 into L7 in one sentence.

Q094 · Ch10 L84 · low

Now: “way two people speak to each other all came up.”

Problem: The Pillemer paragraph is orphaned and connects to nothing.

Fix: way two people speak to each other all came up. Those are the three places the lines in this chapter live.

My call: Accept as written.

Q047 · Ch10 L224 · medium

Now: “Most men hand that job to their wife.”

Problem: One of six crowd foils in Ch10, the heaviest cluster in the book.

Fix: 224: ’It’s easy to hand that job to your wife.’ 50: ’If you’ve never answered that question out loud, that’s exactly why the rule folds…’ 121: ’The third one is the hardest.’

My call: Accept all three lines (224, 50, 121).

Q095 · Ch10 L273 · low

Now: “You’re not holding any of this to win, you’re holding it because your marriage”

Problem: A comma splice in the chapter’s last line.

Fix: You’re not holding any of this to win. You’re holding it because your marriage is what’s on the other side of it.

My call: Accept as written.

Q050 · Ch11 L77 · medium

Now: “These are examples of words you might use, not claims that she will agree.”

Problem: A liability-voice disclaimer breaks the guide's register.

Fix: Delete the sentence.

My call: Accept: delete.

Q098 · Ch11 L113 · low

Now: "You can be disappointed by her response and still be glad you spoke honestly."

Problem: 'You can [A] and still [B]' appears four times in Ch11 and is the later chapters' signature shape; the count is for voice_check.py to confirm.

Fix: Ch11 117: 'Staying calm in an argument doesn't mean you've started the discussion that needs to happen.'; Ch11 29: 'Disliking part of the visit doesn't mean you don't want to go.'

My call: Accept both lines (117 and 29).

Q099 · Ch12 L7 · low

Now: “Nobody established that number. Being there is the part that counts.”

Problem: An unclear dismissal of the weekly-date advice.

Fix: I don’t know where that number came from. What counts is that you actually go.

My call: Accept as written.

Q101 · Ch12 L51 · low

Now: “Winning favor isn’t trading for it, either.”

Problem: The reader has to rebuild who trades what.

Fix: ’Trying to win her favor doesn’t mean expecting payment for it.’

My call: Accept as written.

Q102 · Ch12 L83 · low

Now: “He was a Stoic, and the notebook is *Meditations*.”

Problem: Talks down to a reader the audience file says already knows Marcus.

Fix: Delete the sentence.

My call: Accept: delete.

Q104 · Ch13 L3 · low

Now: “The gap between those two is small enough to miss for years.”

Problem: Reuses Ch1’s key term ’gap’ for a new meaning (attention), the same drift fixed in Ch6.

Fix: ’The difference is small enough to miss for years.’

My call: Accept as written.

Q105 · Ch13 L23 · low

Now: “The date you can’t plan.”

Problem: Ch12 and Ch13 both centre on ’the date’ (deferred in inbox 112).

Fix: **The Saturday you can’t plan.**

My call: Accept as written.

Q109 · Ch14 L21 · low

Now: “In a 2014 classroom study, Froh and colleagues taught children aged eight to eleven”

Problem: A study of schoolchildren interrupts the author’s warmest domestic paragraph.

Fix: Cut it, or move it to an endnote.

My call: Cut it (the source stays in the OKF); the book has no endnotes.

Q111 · Ch14 L31 · low

Now: “When either of you catches yourself comparing, you can say so kindly.”

Problem: Invites the misreading ’tell her I noticed someone else’ (warmth review item, softened but still present).

Fix: When you catch yourself comparing, look back at the whole of the woman in front of you.

My call: Accept as written.

Q131 · Ch16 L41 · low

Now: “Every act of compassion you carry out is a gift to your marriage.”

Problem: A greeting-card line that ends the section and adds a ’gift’ image.

Fix: Delete.

My call: Accept: delete.

Q133 · Ch16 L53 · low

Now: “You each come from a family, and both sides need time and patience.”

Problem: Placed right after ’the guests who don’t take care of the place’ (L51), the families can read as the bad guests in the parallel list.

Fix: Put the families sentence last in L53: ’… The kids need more than either of you planned on. You each come from a family, and both sides need time and patience.’

My call: Accept as written (reorder only).

Q134 · Ch16 L75 · low

Now: “Applying that to a whole marriage is my idea, not his. So is pairing it with three words,”

Problem: Joins the later chapters’ caveat shape (Q053), though it is the chapter’s only one and the outline requires ’said so’.

Fix: Optional: ’Taking it to a whole marriage, and pairing it with three words, two of them

Greek terms the Stoics used, is my step, not his.’

My call: Reject. It’s Ch16’s only caveat, and the spec requires saying the step is yours. The fix is optional by the desk’s own account.

Q135 · Ch16 L77 · low

Now: “The first word is one you already know.”

Problem: Announces the next sentence.

Fix: ’The first word is equanimity, which Chapter 1 described as staying calm and steady on the inside.’

My call: Accept as written.

Q137 · Ch16 L97 · low

Now: “Your kids. Your parents. Your siblings. The people you work with. Your wife.”

Problem: The early chapters' fragment list, the one place Ch16 drops its later register.

Fix: 'Your kids, your parents, your siblings and the people you work with all need you to show up, and so does your wife.'

My call: Accept as written.

Batch 2: pick a wording (40)

Small, but the desks offer two fixes or disagree, or it touches an opening, closing or image.

Q063 · Prologue L33 · low: Windup; inbox 101 backlog item, still present.

Q016 · Prologue L41 · medium: A universal claim that sorts men morally (backlog, still present).

Q017 · Prologue L43 · medium: A verdict after a diagnosis of inherited expectations

(backlog, still present).

Q020 · Ch1 L5 · medium: Dismisses her actual concern on page one of Ch1 (backlog, still present).

Q066 · Ch1 L19 · low: Windup (backlog, still present).

Q022 · Ch1 L73 · medium: Makes a promise the book doesn't keep (the device is capped from Ch15) and uses 'unpack', a word on the audience file's avoid list.

Q026 · Ch2 L52 · medium: An invented crowd of lesser men as a foil (backlog, still present).

Q031 · Ch3 L57 · medium: Negative social proof (backlog, still present).

Q032 · Ch3 L95 · medium: Casts her as the scorekeeper the book later takes apart, and

closes on a threat.

Q073 · Ch4 L43 · low: Clinical indirection (backlog, still present).

Q077 · Ch4 L93 · low: A second image stacked on the nail parable. *(Moved up by the Publisher: changes an opening, closing or image, so it is your taste, not mechanics.)*

Q033 · Ch5 L15 · medium: Contagion-as-invasion framing (backlog, still present).

Q078 · Ch5 L19 · low: The heading keeps the nail image whose meaning changed, which the 2026-09-23 fix removed from the body.

Q035 · Ch5 L65 · medium: Third person in a second-person book: the reader watches a model husband (still present from the 2026-09-23 backlog).

Q039 · Ch7 L15 · medium: Repeats the chapter’s own opening lines almost word for word.

Q042 · Ch8 L15 · medium: ’Traditional’ mislabels the husband’s example (backlog, still present).

Q086 · Ch8 L19 · low: Management and therapy vocabulary close to the avoided ’emotional labor’ (backlog, still present).

Q091 · Ch9 L43 · low: Windup (backlog, still present).

Q045 · Ch9 L47 · medium: The four questions that follow are not Ch1’s four, and they come in a different order.

Q046 · Ch10 L60 · medium: Windup plus negative social proof (backlog, still present).

Q007 · Ch10 L147 · high: The refrain ’You hold it anyway.’ directly follows the safety sentence, so it reads as ’stay in harm’s way’.

Q096 · Ch11 L3 · low: Repeats Ch1’s lying-in-bed replay staging.

Q051 · Ch11 L119 · medium: Turns Ch1’s four virtues into five qualities, and L121’s self-control sentence already covers trying again.

Q052 · Ch11 L131 · medium: Part II has no closing beat; Ch5 closes Part I but Ch11 ends on a complaint script with no handoff to the Sun.

Q054 · Ch12 L15 · medium: Contradicts Ch1’s careful account of what the author inherited (the sulk and the cutting sentence, not the yelling).

Q103 · Ch12 L87 · low: The close mixes ’necessary things’ with ’muscle’. *(Moved up by the Publisher: changes an opening, closing or image, so it is your taste, not mechanics.)*

Q106 · Ch13 L61 · low: Ends on the opening’s failure (the phone) rather than on her; the 2026-10-02 warmth fix was not applied. *(Moved up by the Publisher: changes an opening, closing or image, so it is your taste, not mechanics.)*

Q108 · Ch14 L11 · low: A muddled comparison.

Q008 · Ch14 L29 · high: The logic doesn’t follow, and it reads as a dig.

Q057 · Ch14 L73 · medium: The chapter ends on a moral after a stronger image close. *(Moved up by the Publisher: changes an opening, closing or image, so it is your taste, not mechanics.)*

Q113 · Ch15 L15 · low: A garbled sentence.

Q009 · Ch15 L23 · high: Gives a defensive reader licence to treat every complaint as her mood, and contradicts Ch3's 'she has the outside view of your behavior'.

Q059 · Ch15 L41 · medium: Management-deck filler.

Q114 · Ch15 L71 · low: A double ending after the author-confirmed ah-ha (L69), and the third 'roll up your sleeves'. *(Moved up by the Publisher: changes an opening, closing or image, so it is your taste, not mechanics.)*

Q129 · Ch16 L3 · low: Assumes a reader in a good stretch; Paul, in crisis, is told the capstone describes someone else's marriage. *(Moved up by the Publisher: changes an opening, closing or image, so it is your taste, not mechanics.)*

Q117 · Ch16 L7 · medium: After a good orientation at L3, L5-9 state the thesis and describe the chapter's own role before any scene; 'It's the capstone, the piece that sits on top of everything you've done so far' explains its own metaphor. *(Moved up by the Publisher: changes an opening, closing or image, so it is your taste, not mechanics.)*

Q119 · Ch16 L35 · medium: Re-serves Ch13's close and Ch15's chore line nearly verbatim, while the capstone never gathers Part III by name as Ch5 does Part I. *(Moved up by the Publisher: changes an opening, closing or image, so it is your taste, not mechanics.)*

Q123 · Ch16 L71 · medium: About 700 words of definitions (flow, Csikszentmihalyi, equanimity, arête, eudaimonia) sit where the capstone should be warmest; Paul skims, Eric wants it.

Q124 · Ch16 L83 · medium: L79 makes arête all four of Ch1's checks; L83 maps it to Part II strength, an internal mismatch an evidence-minded reader catches.

Q125 · Ch16 L85 · medium: Invents a confused crowd so the reader can stand apart from it.

Batch 3: your facts or your word (17)

Small, but only you know the answer (your story, your feelings), or a source needs checking.

Q001 · Prologue L17 · high: The Prologue says both always worked full time; Ch14 says she has been on a three-year sabbatical as a full-time mother.

Q005 · Ch1 L71 · high: Ch1 reserves the ’best husband’ question for afterward, but Ch8 and Ch15 use it mid-moment as ’Chapter 1’s question’.

Q070 · Ch2 L46 · low: The only Marcus quotation not in the house’s Long translation.

Q028 · Ch2 L78 · medium: Still present: a verdict that repeats what line 76 already says.

Q006 · Ch4 L63 · high: Still present from inbox 101; a verdict that contradicts the chapter’s own account of anger as an involuntary first motion.

Q040 · Ch7 L25 · medium: Pillemer’s interview pool is described differently in Ch10.

Q097 · Ch11 L27 · low: ’Tolerate’ three times frames her friendships as something he endures. *(Moved up by the Publisher: says*

how you feel about her friendships; only you can say it.)

Q049 · Ch11 L37 · medium: The decade she carried the income is used only for his self-denial, with no word of thanks to her.

Q100 · Ch12 L37 · low: Reads as a transaction and has to be walked back at L51; the reports disagree (persona report: the author's chosen language; warmth review: change it).

Q055 · Ch12 L77 · medium: An unsourced empirical claim plus a garbled research clause, in front of an evidence-oriented reader.

Q112 · Ch14 L53 · low: Unclear whether the Avatar gesture is the remedy for hollow thanks or one more ritual.

Q115 · Ch16 L15 · high: Splits what the interview records as one argument (silence,

then the line aloud) into two events; ’Another time’ is not the author’s; Ch1 calls its version ’the first time’; ’In Chapter 1’ dates an event to a chapter.

Q116 · Ch16 L25 · high: Reads as ’keep the doctrine silent’, which Ch1 shows was the same failure; a defensive reader returns to Ch1’s quiet withdrawal.

Q118 · Ch16 L27 · medium: The Introduction’s sixth failure mode is exactly Ch16’s two frames (calm gone wrong, investing) and is never called back; Ch16 instead says ’cold’, the Introduction’s word for the oak without the sun.

Q122 · Ch16 L59 · medium: Makes the calendar a pillar and a verdict, against Ch12’s ’the date matters less than the thought’ and the author’s own forgotten-anniversary confession.

Q136 · Ch16 L87 · low: Echoes the line L25 scolds. The skeptic says it licenses the line as a joke; the continuity editor says the rhyme is deliberate and works. Not averaged.

Q138 · Ch16 L99 · low: A one-line imperative close, the fifth in the last eight chapters (Q044), and it carries none of the house words the outline asked for ('his point in house words').

Batch 4: medium work (31)

A paragraph or a cross-chapter repeat; best done with the Line Editor, chapter by chapter.

Q014 · Prologue · medium: Counted voice rule: you-density 30.7 per 1,000 (floor 40).

Q002 · Prologue L37 · high: The book's central reveal (the armor mistake) is told in full and resolved in the Prologue, retold in

Ch1 and re-corrected in Ch2, leaving Ch16 nothing new to reveal.

Q015 · Prologue to Ch1 L37 · medium: The disappearance story is told in full in both the Prologue and Ch1, and both lift lines from the voice spec’s own example.

Q018 · Introduction · medium: Counted voice rule: you-density 29.9 per 1,000 (floor 40).

Q019 · Ch1 · medium: Counted voice rule: you-density 33.0 per 1,000 (floor 40).

Q024 · Ch2 to Ch5 to Ch8 · medium: Still present: three recap openings across Parts I-II.

Q067 · Ch2 · low: Counted voice rule: em-dash: 1 in prose (cap 0).

Q068 · Ch2 to Ch10 L6 · low: Nearly word for word the same as Ch2 5’s biography line.

Q072 · Ch3 to Ch4 L83 · low: Ch3 35 ’updated her model’ and Ch4 83 ’updated sense’ echo across consecutive chapters that both end at her withdrawing trust.

Q038 · Ch6 to Ch8 L59 · medium: Ch6-8 each close or near-close on a forward pointer instead of an image.

Q083 · Ch7 · low: Counted voice rule: ’That’s not X. That’s Y.’ reframe x3 (cap 2), REVIEW.

Q044 · Ch9 to Ch15 · medium: Four of the last seven chapters end on the same one-line ’when X, do Y’ imperative.

Q093 · Ch10 to Ch7 L82 · low: An orphan paragraph, and it describes the Pillemer sample differently from Ch7.

Q048 · Ch11 to Ch15 · medium: The later chapters use instructional beat labels; the

archetype asks for evocative ones.

Q053 · Ch12 to Ch15 · medium: The same research-caveat sentence recurs across four chapters and reads like a methods section.

Q056 · Ch13 to Ch15 · medium: Study inserts with caveats cool the later chapters just as they warm up, the one place the later voice is weaker.

Q107 · Ch14 to Ch15 · low: By Ch15 the reader holds a verbatim file of the wife's complaints ('hoarders', 'very anxious', the Saturday lines), and the wife will read the book.

Q110 · Ch14 to Ch15 L23 · low: The identical pointer appears in Ch14 67 and Ch15 23.

Q128 · Ch16 to book · medium: About 10 back-references in about 2,100 words, the

densest in the book; the capstone reads like a review instead of arriving.

Q130 · Ch16 to Ch2 L31 · low: Points to Ch2 but drops Ch2's named handle, so 'compassion' arrives as if it were a new mechanism rather than the same one renamed.

Q120 · Ch16 to Ch2 L37 · medium: Re-teaches preferred indifferents and repeats Ch2's sentence word for word.

Q121 · Ch16 L49 · medium: 'place' stands in for 'house' five times (L49, L51 x2, L63, L93), apparently to stay under the metaphor cap; the declared single image is never plainly named until the Introduction quote.

Q132 · Ch16 to Introduction L51 · low: 'seasons' replaced 'weather' to keep clear of the Oak, but Introduction 37 uses 'seasons' in the Oak section (and Prologue 13 uses it too).

Q011 · book · medium: River, oak and sun are almost absent from chapter prose: the oak never appears, the sun appears once in Ch15, which breaks the elements-only-in-preambles rule.

Q012 · book · medium: Marcus gets his private-notebook biography in five chapters, Epictetus his in three, and the dichotomy of control is explained from scratch four times.

Q013 · book · medium: Five chapters open on ’There’s/There are a [thing] you didn’t choose or notice.’

Q060 · book · low: Citation and typography style drifts between chapters.

Q061 · book · low: ’Tuesday’ is the default day across the book.

Q062 · book · low: ’Tuesday’ is the stock ordinary day in seven chapters.

Q126 · outline to ch24 to ch26 · medium: Ch16 now pre-empts Ch24's daily-investment ah-ha and adds a fourth upkeep image (the house) to Ch24's one image in three places; it gives Ch25's 'Arête question returned' and eudaimonia their antecedent; and its 'She's my best friend' sits against Ch26's ah-ha.

Q127 · book · medium: Arête is first named in Ch16 (inbox 164). The panel reads this as correct (concept first, word later), on condition that the word does not lie unused from Ch16 to Ch25.

Batch 5: the big ones (5)

The early-chapter register pass and new author stories for Ch3-5; these need an interview.

Q003 · Ch1 to Ch5 · high: The early chapters read worse than Ch12-15 because of fragment chains carrying explanation, near-zero author

presence, ’most men’ foils and closing verdict lines, not sentence length alone.

Q004 · Ch1 to Ch5 · high: The early chapters run on fragment chains, ’Not X. Not Y.’ stacks and a punchline at the end of nearly every paragraph; that, more than length, is why readers prefer Ch11-15.

Q030 · Ch3 to Ch5 · medium: Ch3, Ch4 and Ch5 have no story from the author’s own marriage, which is what makes Ch12-15 read better.

Q058 · Ch15 L5 · medium: Ch15 opens with the principle and then a table of contents.

Q010 · Ch16 · high: Ch16 must close Part III by giving what the Prologue and Ch1 have not: her words once, duration, cost, the turn, and the oak-plus-sun integration.